

Poetry Reading





About the Course

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view

online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: *Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard*

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: *The Shrubbery*

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?

∞ Link: *To a Mouse*

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: *Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798*

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their *Lyrical Ballads*, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)

2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"

My heart leaps up when I behold

A rainbow in the sky:

So was it when my life began;

So is it now I am a man;

So be it when I shall grow old,

Or let me die!

The Child is father of the Man;

And I could wish my days to be

Bound each to each by natural piety.

3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"

4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"

• NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 3 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

□ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's A Child's Garden of Verses.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

• How would you describe the speaker of this poem?

• The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are note taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.11-16

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.17-22

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.23-29

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.30-35

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 5 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Shelley

WEEK 6 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.36-40

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

WEEK 7 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.41-46

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

Keats

WEEK 8 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Keats

WEEK 8 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Click [THIS text](#) or scan the QR code for links.



Term 1	
Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems. p.47-50 • What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?	
WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19 <i>Lightening Dreamer</i>	
WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20 <i>Rabindranath Tagore, cont.</i> Materials: The Crescent Moon → RECAP What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it? → READ & DISCUSS Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems. p.51-54, anthems? • What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?	
WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21 <i>Lightening Dreamer</i>	
WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22 <i>Tagore - Fireflies</i>	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam</i>	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam</i>	

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or
scan the QR code
for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37	
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38	
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39	
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40	
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41	
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42	
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43	
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44	
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45	
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46	
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47	
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48	

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49
WEEK 1	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51
WEEK 2	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53
WEEK 3	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55
WEEK 4	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57
WEEK 5	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59
WEEK 6	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61
WEEK 7	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63
WEEK 8	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65
WEEK 9	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67
WEEK 10	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69
WEEK 11	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71
WEEK 12	15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72